

The Boston Globe

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WEDNESDAY, JULY 29, 2026

N.H. could still be first primary, despite DNC

Much is up in the air, but the state may still have a workaround

By James Pindell
GLOBE STAFF

The decision by the Democratic National Committee on Friday to downgrade New Hampshire's traditional role as the first presidential primary in the nation to the third contest raised a lot of questions — especially considering there is a state law requiring the Granite

State to hold the first primary. Further complicating matters is the fact that Republicans in 2028 will continue to use the traditional schedule for their presidential primary season, with the Iowa caucuses first, followed by the New Hampshire primary, then South Carolina and Nevada. Democrats, meanwhile, are poised to blow up that calendar entirely. They aim to have the South Carolina primary first, followed by Nevada, New Hampshire, Michigan, New Mexico, and Virginia. Super Tuesday would come afterward. (This order is not official un-

til the full DNC membership votes on it in August.) Some of the bigger questions about the DNC's decision will only be answered as the situation plays out over the next year and a half. But a few things are becoming immediately clear. Let's go through them. **New Hampshire has a clever workaround, for now** Reread this sentence: New Hampshire will always hold the nation's first presidential primary. The question is whether that first primary will *matter*. Will there be

candidates who apply to be on the ballot? Will voters bother to show up? Will anyone actually care about the results? On that, we just don't know yet. For now, the modus operandi for New Hampshire Democrats is really clear: Don't do a single thing to trigger the DNC into saying New Hampshire has gone rogue. Buried within the DNC rules is a provision that if a candidate campaigns in a state that is not in compliance with the calendar the DNC approves, that candidate can be banned from participating in de-

ANALYSIS, Page A6

Cameras might bring crackdown on speeders

Beacon Hill may be ready to back change this time

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts could soon allow traffic speed cameras to proliferate on city roads and state highways after a decade of proposals failed to cross the finish line at the State House. A provision state senators slipped into a \$575 million economic development bill last week would permit automated cameras in school zones and other designated "safety zones," as well as near active highway construction sites, across the state. Drivers caught going 11 miles per hour over the posted limit would face fines between \$25 and \$100. The shift to cameras would mark a "fairly large change in enforcement," said state Senator William Brownsberger, a Belmont Democrat who sponsored the measure. "This is something we've been pushing for step by step, and these cameras are going to go to places where people are asking for them desperately." Bills allowing for traffic cameras have long languished on Beacon Hill, bogged down by concerns about the cameras' efficacy and recurring debates about invasions of privacy and potentially inflaming racial disparities in communities of color. Already, Black and Hispanic drivers are pulled over and arrested at disproportionately higher rates than white drivers, research shows. But the needle has already started to move on

SPEED CAMERAS, Page A10

A BATTLE IN THEIR WAKE

The sport has its proponents in Vt., but others say it's dangerous in many ways



JIM DAVIS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE



PAUL HEINTZ/GLOBE STAFF

Wake sports are now banned on Lake Fairlee (top), where Josiah Weeks and his daughters had a day on the beach. Lake Champlain is still an option for Clark Crary.

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

FAIRLEE, Vt. — To Emily Doe, there was nothing quite like being out on the lake on a hot summer day surfing a 2-to-4-foot wave thrown up by a wake boat. "It's like snowboarding, but on the water," she said of the specialized boats that generate a wake so large that boarders don't even need to be towed by a rope. This summer, however, the waves have dissipated on Lake Fairlee, a popular destination in the foothills of the Upper Valley, where Doe and her family own one of the many vacation homes. Vermont recently banned wake boats on most inland lakes, including Fairlee, following a years-long, often acrimonious debate that pitted one group of recreationists against another — and raised questions about how best to protect and enjoy the state's natural environment. "It got nasty," said Doe, who lives on the seacoast of New Hampshire but has summered on Lake Fairlee most of her life. "It's just become us against them, and it's disappointing."

VERMONT, Page A7

A big, big issue for movie lovers

Want to see 'The Odyssey' in 70mm IMAX? Good luck finding a theater.

By Celine Hijazi
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

PROVIDENCE — Before a 2 p.m. Wednesday showing of Christopher Nolan's "The Odyssey," Apple Cinemas at Providence Place was packed. Inside the theater, employees as well as moviegoers shared the same understanding: this wasn't just another screening. That's because Apple Cinemas Providence Place is one of only 26 theaters in the United States showing "The Odyssey" in 70mm IMAX — the format Nolan shot the film in, and the first, according to IMAX, shot entirely on a new model of IMAX film cameras. You can still see "The Odyssey" in other formats at theaters around the region; most movies, in fact are distributed in digital, not film, format, although in recent years, multiple directors have used 70mm film, including Nolan, Steven Spielberg, and others, for its stronger image resolution.

IMAX, Page A7

From inside, a critical voice on hospital merger

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Dr. Michael Jellinek has worked at Massachusetts General Hospital for 50 years. A prominent child psychiatrist who went into hospital administration, he rose to become president of Newton-Wellesley Hospital and then chief clinical officer of MGH's corporate parent, Partners HealthCare, later renamed Mass General Brigham. Given his deep roots at MGB, Jellinek, 77, who still practices child psychiatry, said it was hard to write a recent commentary in a peer-reviewed journal criticizing how the state's largest health care system merged the clinical departments of MGH and Brigham and Women's Hospital begin-

ning in 2024. But the episode made a valuable case study, given that more than 1,900 hospitals and health systems merged in the United States from 1998 to 2023, he wrote. His article, published in May in Academic Medicine, says leaders consolidated the two hospitals' medical departments and divisions in a "stunning top-down decision" that cost some physician managers their jobs or caused them to leave and hurt morale. The corporate operations of MGH and Brigham had been combined for 30 years but not their clinical functions. The merger resulted in MGH and Brigham, long the frenemies of Boston medicine, as a 2024 Globe article put it,

JELLINEK, Page A10



DANIEL SARCH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

"This was like an earthquake in the hallways. I'd been through one earthquake — when MGB and Brigham merged [corporate operations] under Partners 30 years ago, that was an earthquake. This one was even bigger," said Dr. Michael Jellinek.



Buckets, sheets

Wednesday: Thunderstorms. High 70-75. Low 61-66.
Thursday: Quieter, cool. High 65-70. Low 61-66.
Sunrise: 5:34 Sunset: 8:07
Weather and Comics, G6-7.

VOL. 310, NO. 29

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00

The number of new immigrants enrolling in Massachusetts high schools fell 20 percent within the first few months of President Trump's second term. **B1.**

A 7.1 magnitude earthquake shook Japan's southern main island of Kyushu, leaving dozens of people injured or missing. **A3.**

A couple agreed to a final \$55.7 million settlement of their suit against eBay and former top executives. **B5.**

Curtis Mead, the Red Sox' newest pickup, has a broken wrist after being hit by a pitch in his first game. **C1.**

Lune might be the best restaurant on the Cape right now, writes Devra First, who gives it five stars. **G1.**

